

MEDITATION

Yoga was traditionally seen as a way to prepare the body for meditation. Today, many yoga classes include meditative elements, such as mindfulness practices and chanting “om,” as ways to relax the body and mind. Science shows that the benefits of these meditative practices also extend into your daily life.

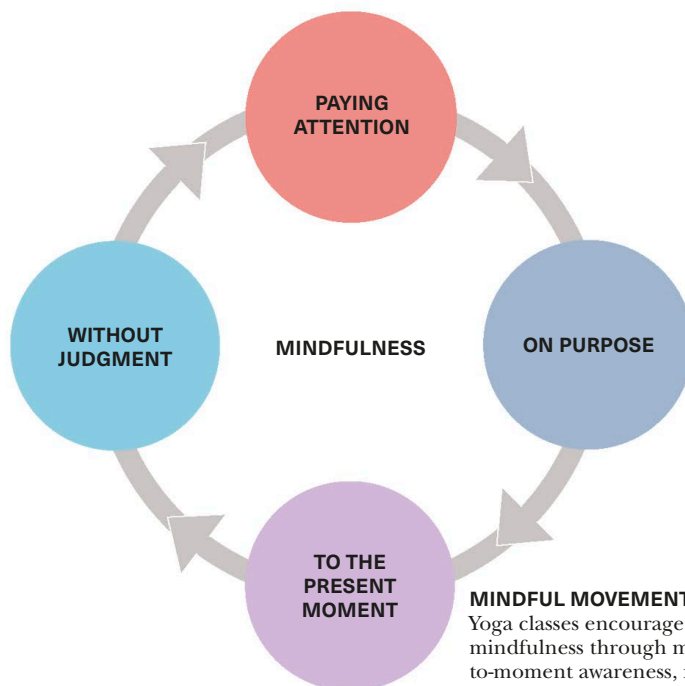
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*Simply observe
your thoughts
arising. It's like
watching clouds
pass by while
remaining aware
of the vast, clear
blue sky.*

Q IS MINDFULNESS THE SAME AS MEDITATION? HOW IS IT PRACTICED?

Mindfulness is a simple and popular type of meditation that is often practiced in traditional seated poses. It also refers to a mindset that you can bring into the rest of your life. According to Jon Kabat-Zinn, PhD, founder of the well-researched Mindfulness-Based

Stress Reduction (MBSR) program, mindfulness can be defined as deliberately paying attention to the present moment without judgment. It often involves observing breath, thoughts, sounds, or physical sensations, all of which are encouraged in yoga practice.



MINDFUL MOVEMENT

Yoga classes encourage mindfulness through moment-to-moment awareness, for example during asanas. You may notice this mindset spilling into your daily life, making even menial tasks, such as washing the dishes, mindful.